

AMERICAN JOB CENTERS AND WIOA

State Employment Leadership Network (SELN) Annual Meeting

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Today's Objectives

- ✓ Overview of American Job Centers
- ✓ WIOA and the Final Rules
 - ◆ Promotes Physical and Programmatic Access
 - ◆ Strategic Alignment of WIOA Programs
 - ◆ Clarifies Competitive Integrated Employment
- ✓ Technical Assistance Updates
- ✓ Q&A

2

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Overview of American Job Centers

as of September 29, 2016

Total (mapped): 2,440 Comprehensive: 1,619 Affiliate: 821

3

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Overview of American Job Centers

❖ AJC services to the individual can include:

- ◆ Resource rooms with phones, free internet, and resume writing tools;
- ◆ Job training services;
- ◆ Job search assistance;
- ◆ Career counseling;
- ◆ Labor market and employer information;
- ◆ Employment workshops;
- ◆ Hiring events and business service information;
- ◆ Access to state's job bank; and
- ◆ Unemployment insurance information.

4

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Overview of American Job Centers

❖ Customer Centered Design Initiative by DOL

- ◆ Putting the people you serve at the center of your design process to come up with new answers to difficult problems.
- ◆ Using empathy and emotion to develop better services in the workforce business of serving people.
- ◆ Design Challenge Question: *How might we work with our partners to design services that are physically and programmatically accessible to individuals with disabilities?*



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Overview of American Job Centers

❖ AJC services to the employer can include:

- ◆ Listing job openings;
- ◆ Hosting job fairs;
- ◆ Connections to other partners and programs, when necessary;
- ◆ Training and technical assistance regarding the employment of individuals with disabilities;
- ◆ Facilitating work-based learning experiences (apprenticeships); and
- ◆ Recruiting qualified applicants who are individuals with disabilities



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Overview of American Job Centers

❖ Find your closest American Job Center at www.careeronestop.org (under Find Local Help tab)

❖ American Job Centers are both funded and coordinated by Department of Labor's Employment and Training Administration (ETA)

❖ DOL has six regional offices with headquarters:

<u>Region 1</u> – Boston	<u>Region 4</u> – Boston
<u>Region 2</u> – Philadelphia	<u>Region 5</u> – Chicago
<u>Region 3</u> – Atlanta	<u>Region 6</u> – San Francisco



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Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act (WIOA)

❖ On July 22, 2014, the Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act (WIOA) was signed into law. The programs within these titles are referenced as core programs.

- ◆ Title I – Adult, Dislocated Worker and Youth formula programs administered by Labor
- ◆ Title II – The Adult Education and Literacy program administered by Education
- ◆ Title III– Wagner-Peyser Act employment services program administered by Labor
- ◆ Title IV– the programs (VR) under title I of the Rehabilitation Act administered by Education



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WIOA Rules – Latest Developments

- ❖ Approximately 2,800 public comments received on Joint Rule and four program specific rules.
- ❖ On June 30, 2016, the U.S. Departments of Labor and Education made the Final Rules publicly available. They can be found at www.doleta.gov/wioa.
- ❖ One of the five WIOA final rules publicly released is titled Joint Rule for Unified and Combined State Plans, Performance Accountability, and the One-Stop Joint Provisions.

9

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WIOA Reforms and Disability

- ❖ How do WIOA reforms improve service delivery to individuals with disabilities?
 - ◆ Promotes Physical and Programmatic Access
 - ◆ Strategically Aligns WIOA Programs
 - ◆ Clarifies Competitive Integrated Employment

10

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Promotes Physical and Programmatic Access – Section 188 of WIOA

- ❖ The joint rules establish that all comprehensive American Job Centers and affiliated sites must be physically and programmatically accessible, as described in 29 CFR part 38, the implementing regulations of WIOA section 188.
- ❖ Section 188 implements the non-discrimination and equal opportunity provisions of WIOA.
- ❖ DOL published guidance to help states set standards through “Achieving Universal Access and Equal Opportunity – Section 188 Reference Guide”

11

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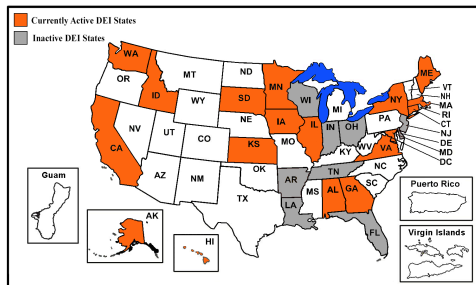
Promotes Physical and Programmatic Access – Roles and Responsibilities

- ❖ The State Board establishes the objective criteria and procedures. It must review and update the criteria every two years as part of the review and modification of State Plans.
- ❖ The Local Board applies the criteria when certifying American Job Centers every three years.
- ❖ Standing Committees may be established within the Local Board. One of the standing committees identified include services to individuals with disabilities.

12

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Promotes Physical and Programmatic Access - Disability Employment Initiative



13

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Promotes Physical and Programmatic Access – Disability Employment Initiative

❖ On September 14th, DOL announced six states to receive nearly \$15 million in DEI Round VII funding. Those states include the following:

- ◆ California (Adult Population Focus)
- ◆ Connecticut (Youth Population Focus)
- ◆ Idaho (Youth Population Focus)
- ◆ Maryland (Significant Disability Population Focus)
- ◆ Massachusetts (Youth Population Focus)
- ◆ Minnesota (Youth Population Focus)

14

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Strategically Aligns Across WIOA Programs – State Plans

- ❖ State Plans- Ensuring that federal core program employment and training services are coordinated and complemented by requiring a single, 4-year strategic State Plan for achieving the work goals of the state.
- ❖ 27 Unified State Plans and 30 Combined State Plans submitted.
- ❖ State and Local Plans must describe how the AJC will comply with the nondiscrimination requirements regarding physical and programmatic accessibility of facilities, programs, services, technology and materials, including appropriate staff training and support.

15

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Strategically Aligns Across WIOA Programs – State Plans

- ❖ State Plans include strategies surrounding Career Pathways, strategic partnerships, and regional planning.
- ❖ Career Pathways
 - ◆ In April 2016, 12 federal agencies signed a joint letter promoting the use of career pathways to assist youth and adults with acquiring marketable skills and industry-recognized credentials through better alignment of education, training, employment, and human and social services among public agencies and employers.

16

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Strategically Aligns Across WIOA Programs – State Plans

- ❖ The six key elements of Career Pathways include:
 - ◆ Build Cross-Agency Partnerships
 - ◆ Identify Industry Sector and Engage Employers
 - ◆ Design Education and Training Programs
 - ◆ Identify Funding Needs and Sources
 - ◆ Align Policies and Programs
 - ◆ Measures System Change and Performance

17

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Strategically Aligns on Roles and Responsibilities – Partnerships

- ❖ WIOA emphasizes planning across multiple partner programs to ensure alignment in service delivery.
 - ◆ U.S. Social Security Administration Ticket to Work (TTW) program
 - ◆ Centers for Independent Living (CILs)

18

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Strategically Aligns Across WIOA Programs – Performance Accountability

- ❖ Performance Accountability – Ensuring that federal investments in employment and training programs by establishing a common performance accountability system.
- ❖ All State Plans include expected levels of performance for certain primary indicators of performance. Those indicators are the basis for negotiations that the Departments and the State used to establish negotiated levels of performance.
- ❖ Grantees began the process of collecting data for WIOA performance accountability on July 1, 2016.

19

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Strategically Aligns Across WIOA Programs - Performance Accountability

- ❖ Leading changes resulting from the WIOA and Joint Final Rule concerning performance accountability include the following:
 - ◆ Establish primary performance indicators for the six core programs;
 - ◆ Align data elements and definitions;
 - ◆ Require a statistical adjustment model to be used;
 - ◆ Standardize annual reports and provide easy-to-understand performance information for consumers; and
 - ◆ Require sanctions for performance failure or failure to report.

20

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Clarifies Competitive Integrated Employment

- ❖ Competitive Integrated Employment Standard. In order to satisfy the definition of competitive integrated employment as a successful employment outcome, the employment must satisfy the requirements for all three components:
 - ◆ Competitive earnings;
 - ◆ Integrated location; and
 - ◆ Opportunities for advancement.
- ❖ Limitations on Use of the Subminimum Wage. Increased limitations have been placed by WIOA on the payment of subminimum wages under Section 14(c) of the Fair Labor Standards Act.

21

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Clarifies Competitive Integrated Employment

- ❖ Advisory Committee. WIOA established an *Advisory Committee on Increasing Competitive Integrated Employment for Individuals with Disabilities*. The final report was submitted to Congress and the Secretary of Labor on September 15, 2016.

22

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Technical Assistance



- ❖ Joint technical assistance is currently available at the Innovation and Opportunity Network (ION) housed on WorkforceGPS, DOL's ETA technical assistance platform. You can visit ION at:
<https://ion.workforcegps.org/>
- ❖ DOL Career Pathways Community of Practice
<https://careerpathways.workforcegps.org>

23

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THANK
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Q&A and
Discussion

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24

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